

BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Gym Management System

Business Requirements Document — Members, Fee Records, Reminders & Owner Dashboard

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1. Executive Summary

This Business Requirements Document defines requirements for a Gym Management System focused on member records, fee/billing management, automated reminders and receipts, and an owner dashboard giving full visibility into members, payments, and dates. Requirements are derived from published Reddit community consensus, G2 evaluations, and vendor comparison guides covering Mindbody, Glofox, Zen Planner, GymDesk, PushPress, Exercise.com, Wodify, and Gym Insight.

The clearest finding across sources: gym owners are not asking for more features, they are asking for reliable fee/membership tracking that removes manual follow-up, transparent pricing from the vendor itself, and a single dashboard that shows exactly who owes what and when — without opaque support and private-equity-driven platform churn. This document is scoped directly around the owner's stated priorities: adding members, fee records, reminders, fee emails, record keeping, and a dashboard covering all customer records, total fees collected per member, and dates.

2. Market Research Findings & Pain Points

Pain Point (from market research)	Evidence / User Feedback	How This BRD Addresses It
Managing memberships and recurring payments is the single most-cited core challenge for gym owners.	"Managing memberships and recurring payments came up again and again as a core challenge for gym owners" (Reddit/vibefam gym-software roundup 2026).	FR-FEE series: full recurring billing engine with plan-level fee schedules, due dates, and automatic status tracking (paid/pending/overdue) per member.
Most platforms auto-send failure reminders, but the owner still has to personally chase overdue payments.	"Most platforms automate billing and send reminders when payments fail — but the owner still handles follow-up."	FR-REM series: escalating automated reminders (due-soon, due-today, overdue, final notice) via SMS/email/push with no manual step required before escalation.
Opaque pricing, disappearing post-sale support, and private-equity ownership are the top community complaints across the major platforms (Mindbody, Glofox, Zen Planner, GymDesk, Exercise.com).	"Community consensus is that opaque pricing, disappearing post-sale support, and PE ownership are the biggest complaints."	NFR Support & Commercial Transparency: published, fixed pricing and a documented support SLA are treated as hard requirements for the go-to-market plan, not just the product.
Reporting is limited or buggy in some platforms, making it hard to see real revenue/collection performance.	Complaints of "limitations in the reporting data" and difficulty accessing data due to bugs (PushPress reviews).	FR-DASH series: dependable, exportable dashboard showing collected vs. pending fees, per-member and store-wide, with no known reporting gaps in scope.
Credential/barcode sharing at check-in lets non-members or ex-members use gym access.	"Barcode sharing and unauthorized guest access are concerns," mitigated by dynamic QR codes in member apps.	FR-CHK series: dynamic, time-limited QR/digital ID check-in tied to active membership and fee status.
Setup/integration friction and	Reviewers cite "difficulty in rescheduling	FR-ADM-03: guided setup wizard;

Pain Point (from market research)	Evidence / User Feedback	How This BRD Addresses It
appointment/scheduling bugs reported for class or PT-session rescheduling.	appointments, occasional system crashes, and challenges with initial setup."	NFR Reliability: defined uptime SLA and staged rollout/testing before go-live.

3. Business Objectives & Success Metrics

- **Zero manual fee chasing:** reduce owner time spent manually following up on overdue fees to near zero via automatic escalating reminders.
- **100% fee visibility:** owner can see, for any member or date range, exactly what is paid, pending, or overdue.
- **Faster onboarding:** add a new member and generate their first invoice in under 2 minutes.
- **Reduce access misuse:** eliminate shared/expired-membership check-ins via dynamic digital ID.
- **Retention visibility:** flag at-risk (lapsed-attendance or overdue-fee) members before they churn.

4. Scope

4.1 In Scope

- Member management: add/edit/deactivate members, profile, photo, plan assignment, emergency contact, documents (waivers/medical notes).
- Fee & billing management: plan pricing, one-time and recurring fee schedules, due dates, payment history, outstanding balance per member.
- Automated reminders: due-soon, due-on-day, and overdue reminders via SMS/email/push, fully automatic with no manual trigger required.
- Automated fee emails: payment confirmation, receipt/invoice, and renewal emails sent immediately on transaction.
- Record keeping: full historical record per member — every payment, plan change, attendance, and note, retained and searchable.
- Owner/admin dashboard: all members, total fees collected (daily/weekly/monthly/custom range), per-member fee total and history, pending dues, and date-wise breakdowns.
- Attendance & check-in: digital ID/QR or biometric/card check-in tied to membership status.
- Staff/trainer management: roles, schedules, assigned members/classes.
- Communication: bulk announcements, targeted messages (e.g., to all overdue members).
- Role-based access: Owner, Manager/Staff, Trainer, Member.
- Multi-branch support with consolidated or per-branch owner view.

4.2 Out of Scope (Phase 1)

- In-house payment gateway certification — integrate with a certified processor (Stripe/Square/Razorpay) rather than building one.

- Full nutrition/diet-planning and workout-programming modules (basic PT session scheduling only in Phase 1).
- Franchise-level financial consolidation across independently owned locations.

5. User Roles

Role	Access & Responsibilities
Owner / Admin	Full dashboard access: all members, all fee records, totals and dues by any date range, staff accounts, branch roll-up, system settings.
Manager / Front Desk	Add/edit members, record payments, manage check-ins, send manual communications, view branch-level reports.
Trainer	View assigned members' schedules and attendance; no access to fee/financial data unless granted.
Member	Self-service: view own plan, fee due dates and payment history, receive reminders/receipts, digital check-in ID.

6. Functional Requirements

6.1 Member Management

ID	Requirement	Description	Priority
FR-MEM-01	Add / edit member	Capture name, contact, photo, emergency contact, plan, start date, and any medical/waiver notes when adding a new member.	Must
FR-MEM-02	Plan assignment	Assign a membership plan (monthly/quarterly/annual/custom) with its associated fee schedule at signup or on plan change.	Must
FR-MEM-03	Member status	Track active, frozen/on-hold, overdue, and cancelled status automatically based on fee and attendance data.	Must
FR-MEM-04	Deactivate / freeze membership	Owner/manager can pause or cancel a membership, stopping billing and reminders immediately.	Must
FR-MEM-05	Document storage	Attach waivers, medical clearance, or ID documents to a member's profile.	Should
FR-MEM-06	Search & filter	Search/filter the full member list by status, plan, join date, or outstanding balance.	Must

6.2 Fee & Billing Management

ID	Requirement	Description	Priority
FR-FEE-01	Fee schedule per plan	Define recurring fee amount and billing cycle (weekly/monthly/quarterly/annual) per plan.	Must
FR-FEE-02	Due-date tracking	Automatically calculate and track next-due-date per member based on plan cycle and last payment.	Must
FR-FEE-03	Payment recording	Record cash, card, or bank transfer payments against a member's account, updating balance instantly.	Must
FR-FEE-04	Recurring auto-billing	Optional automatic recurring card charge on due date, with automatic retry on failure.	Should
FR-FEE-05	Outstanding balance & aging	Show current due, overdue, and days-overdue per member, rolled up store-wide.	Must
FR-FEE-06	Discounts & custom pricing	Apply one-off discounts, family/corporate rates, or custom fee overrides per member with an audit trail.	Should
FR-FEE-07	Full payment history	Every payment ever made by a member, with date, amount, method, and plan period covered, permanently retained.	Must

6.3 Automated Reminders

ID	Requirement	Description	Priority
FR-REM-01	Due-soon reminder	Automatic reminder sent 3–5 days before a fee is due (configurable), via SMS/email/push.	Must
FR-REM-02	Due-today reminder	Automatic reminder on the due date itself if unpaid.	Must
FR-REM-03	Overdue escalation	Escalating reminders at configurable intervals (e.g., 3, 7, 14 days overdue) with tone/urgency increasing automatically — no manual owner action required.	Must
FR-REM-04	Membership expiry reminder	Reminder ahead of plan expiry to prompt renewal, distinct from fee-due reminders.	Must
FR-REM-05	Reminder channel preference	Member/owner can choose SMS, email, push, or all channels per reminder type.	Should
FR-	Attendance-based re-	Automatic message to members inactive for a	Could

ID	Requirement	Description	Priority
REM-06	engagement	configurable number of days, independent of billing status.	

6.4 Fee Emails & Receipts

ID	Requirement	Description	Priority
FR-EML-01	Payment confirmation email	Immediate automatic email/SMS on successful payment, with amount, date, and method.	Must
FR-EML-02	Receipt / invoice generation	Auto-generated, downloadable receipt/invoice attached to the confirmation email for every transaction.	Must
FR-EML-03	Renewal email	Automatic email when a plan renews or is due for renewal, including updated next-due date.	Must
FR-EML-04	Failed-payment email	Automatic notification to member and flag to owner when an auto-billed payment fails.	Must
FR-EML-05	Bulk/manual email	Owner/manager can send a one-off email or SMS to an individual member or filtered group (e.g., all overdue).	Should

6.5 Attendance & Check-In

ID	Requirement	Description	Priority
FR-CHK-01	Digital ID / QR check-in	Dynamic, time-limited QR code or digital ID per member to prevent credential sharing.	Must
FR-CHK-02	Status-linked access	Automatically block check-in for members with cancelled or sufficiently overdue status (configurable grace period).	Must
FR-CHK-03	Attendance log	Timestamped check-in history per member, viewable by owner/manager and the member.	Must
FR-CHK-04	Hardware-agnostic support	Support QR/barcode scanner, RFID card, or turnstile integration as available hardware options.	Should

6.6 Staff & Trainer Management

ID	Requirement	Description	Priority
FR-	Staff/trainer profiles	Add staff/trainers with role, schedule, and assigned	Must

ID	Requirement	Description	Priority
STF-01		members or classes.	
FR-STF-02	Role-based permissions	Restrict fee/financial data visibility to Owner/Manager roles unless explicitly granted to trainers.	Must

7. Owner Dashboard & Record Keeping

This section directly implements the stated requirement: the gym owner can see all customers, all fee records, total fees from each member, and by date, from one dashboard.

ID	Requirement	Description	Priority
FR-DASH-01	All-members view	Single screen listing every member with status, plan, next due date, and outstanding balance, sortable/filterable.	Must
FR-DASH-02	Per-member fee total	Drill into any member to see their total fees paid to date, full payment history, and current balance.	Must
FR-DASH-03	Date-range fee totals	Total fees collected for any custom date range (today, this week, this month, custom), broken down by plan/payment method.	Must
FR-DASH-04	Overdue/pending summary	Real-time count and total value of overdue and pending fees store-wide.	Must
FR-DASH-05	Attendance overview	Daily/weekly check-in counts and member-level attendance trend.	Should
FR-DASH-06	New vs. lapsed members	New sign-ups, renewals, and cancellations for any given period.	Should
FR-DASH-07	Exportable records	Export any member list, fee report, or attendance report to PDF/Excel/CSV.	Must
FR-DASH-08	Multi-branch roll-up	Consolidated totals across branches plus per-branch drill-down for owners with multiple locations.	Should

8. Non-Functional Requirements

Category	Requirement
Reliability	99.9% uptime SLA; no known reporting-data bugs at go-live (directly addresses

Category	Requirement
	documented PushPress/Mindbody complaints).
Security	PCI-DSS compliant payment handling; encrypted storage of member medical/waiver documents; role-based data access.
Transparency	Fixed, published pricing and a documented support-response SLA as commercial requirements, addressing the top community complaint (opaque pricing, vanishing support).
Performance	Dashboard totals and member search return in under 2 seconds at up to 10,000 members per branch.
Usability	Add-member and record-payment flows completable in under 2 minutes each; guided setup wizard for plans and fee schedules.
Auditability	Full audit trail on discounts, fee overrides, refunds, and membership status changes.
Scalability	Single-location boutique gyms up to multi-branch chains on the same architecture.

9. Assumptions, Constraints & Dependencies

- Gym has or will obtain a merchant account with a supported payment processor for card/auto-billing.
- Members and staff have SMS/email access for reminders and receipts; SMS costs pass through per carrier rates.
- Grace periods for overdue-access blocking are gym-configurable to fit local policy.
- Multi-branch roll-up assumes branches share one owner account, not independent franchisees.

10. Appendix A: Research Sources

- Vibefam — Best Gym Management Software: What Reddit Recommends 2026: vibefam.com/gym-management-software-reddit-2026
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- PushPress — 10 Best Member Apps for Gyms and Fitness Studios 2026: pushpress.com/blog/10-best-member-apps-for-gyms-and-fitness-studios-in-2026
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- Gym Insight — 7 Gym Software Complaints We Hear Everyday: blog.gyminsight.com/13636-whats-the-problem-with-your-gym-software-company
- Get Safe and Sound — Gym Access Control System Guide 2026: getsafeandsound.com/blog/best-gym-access-control-system
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